CHAPTER 3

OPENING SCREEN UTILITIES MENU

The Opening Screen Utilities menu includes commands for creating an index or a table of contents and for using the WordStar macro system.

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Utilities
 Index...        I
 TOC...          T
 Macros          ►
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INDEX

Pull-down: ***ALT + U, I***
Classic: ***I***

Creates an index.

You can create an index from entries you've already made in a document, or you can tell WordStar to index every word except those listed in an exclusion list. (Exclusion lists are described later in this section.)

For information on marking index entries in your documents, see "Index/TOC Entry" in "Editing Screen Insert Menu."

Follow these steps to create an index:

1. Choose Utilities→Index, or use the I classic command.

2. In the Index dialog box, specify the name of the file to index. Specify the directory path if necessary.

3. Select any options you want to change. The options are described below.

   Page Numbers Select All (the default) to index the entire file. To specify the pages to index, select Selected Pages and type the page numbers, separated with spaces. You can specify a range by using a hyphen. For example, to index pages 1 through 3 and pages 5 and 7, type **1-3 5 7**. (If you've reassigned page numbers, when you use Selected Pages, indexing starts at the first occurrence of the first number specified, and ends at the first occurrence of the last number specified.)

   Index Every Word If you don't select this check box (the default), WordStar indexes only the entries you've marked and typed. If you select this option, WordStar indexes all those entries, and all the words in the document minus any words that appear in exclusion lists.

   Pages To index only odd or only even pages, select Odd or Even. The default is Both.

4. Press F10 or choose OK to create the index.

WordStar creates an index file that has the same filename as the document with the .IDX extension. All entries in the file are in alphabetical order with the page numbers listed, and duplicate entries are combined. You can edit the index file to make any formatting changes or corrections.

Exclusion lists

An exclusion list is a nondocument file that contains an alphabetical list of words to exclude from an index. WordStar uses two exclusion lists.

The general exclusion list is named WSINDEX.XCL and is supplied with WordStar. It contains a list of the most common words in English (articles, pronouns, prepositions, conjunctions, and so on) that are rarely indexed.

The document-specific exclusion list has the same name as the document for which you are making the index, but with the .XCL extension. To create this list, create a nondocument file with the appropriate name, and type the specific words from your document that you want to exclude from the index. Be sure to type each word on a separate line.

TIP *You can quickly create a document-specific exclusion list. First, use the Index command to index every word in your document. Next, open the index file as a nondocument and delete the words you do want in the index. Then change the extension of the file to .XCL. This file is now an exclusion list.*

TOC

Pull-down: ***ALT + U, T***
Classic: ***T***

Creates a table of contents.

The table of contents is created from entries you've previously inserted in your document. For information on entering table of contents entries, see "Index/TOC Entry" in "Editing Screen Insert Menu."

Follow these steps to create a table of contents:

1. Choose Utilities→TOC, or use the T classic command.

2. In the Table of Contents dialog box, specify the name of the file to create the table of contents for. Specify the directory path if necessary.

3. Select any options you want to change. The options are described below.

   Page Numbers Select All (the default) to include table of contents entries from the entire file. To specify pages, select Selected Pages and type the page numbers, separated with spaces. You can specify a range by using a hyphen. For example, to create a table of contents for pages 1 through 3 and pages 5 and 7, type **1-3 5 7**. (If you've reassigned page numbers, when you use Selected Pages, the table of contents starts at the first occurrence of the first number specified, and ends at the first occurrence of the last number specified.)

Pages To create a table of contents from entries on only odd or only even pages, choose Odd or Even. The default is Both.

4 Press F10 or choose OK to create the table of contents.

WordStar places all the table of contents entries, with page numbers, in a new file that has the same filename as the document with the .TOC extension. You can edit the table of contents file to make any formatting changes or corrections.

If you specified table of contents entries for separate tables of contents using **.tc1**, **.tc2**, and so on, WordStar creates a separate table of contents file for each with the extensions .TO1, .TO2, and so on.

MACROS

Pull-down: ***ALT + U, M***
Classic: ***M***

Records, creates, edits, or runs a macro that enters a longer series of text and commands.

The WordStar macro capabilities allow you to use a few keystrokes to enter a series of keystrokes and commands. For example, you can create a macro so that each time you press Alt+W, the word WordStar is inserted in your text. Or a macro can change the order of two words (mark the first word as a block, move the cursor to the end of the next word, and move the block).

When you choose Macros, the following menu appears.

Play...	MP
Record...	MR
Edit/Create...	MD
Single Step...	MS
Copy...	MO
Delete...	MY
Rename...	ME

You can create a macro in either of two ways:

- Use Record, or the MR classic command, to record keystrokes. This is the easier way to create a macro. WordStar records commands and keystrokes

as you enter them. When you are finished, WordStar compiles them into a macro file that contains all the appropriate macro commands.

- Use Edit/Create, or the MD classic command, to enter macro commands into a file that you edit like a nondocument. To use this command, you need to know the WordStar macro language. This language allows you to create macros that are too complex to record with the Record command. For example, you can repeat a certain action as many times as needed each time you run the macro. The example in "The Macro Language" in "Editing Screen Utilities Menu" enters a bullet character and waits for you to type text, then repeats that sequence after the end of each paragraph; the macro stops and returns you to editing when you finish your bulleted list.

If you need to write a macro that is too complex to record, you can first record a simple macro that contains commands and keystrokes that can be recorded, then use Edit/Create to add the macro language for the rest of the macro. You can also copy a macro and edit it to create a similar one, and you can copy blocks of macro commands from one macro file to another.

After you create a macro, you can use Single Step, or the MS classic command to play it back step by step to identify any problems.

To execute a macro, you can either use a hot key, or use Play or the MP classic command. You can stop the macro by pressing Esc or ^Break. (When a macro is paused for input, you must use ^Break.) You can change the Esc keystroke or add another key to stop a macro in WSCHANGE (DCDC and DCDD).

You can also copy, rename, and delete macros using commands on the Macros menu.

TIP *You can set up a macro to run a series of commands that you frequently use when you start WordStar. Then you can run the macro immediately when you start WordStar by typing* **ws /mmacroname**. *For example, you can set up a macro named LETTER to change to the C:\CUSTOMER directory, open a new file, and read in a file of boilerplate text and formatting. Then, any time you want to start WordStar and start a new letter, type* **ws /mletter**. *If you want to start WordStar, open a file, and then run a macro, type the filename before the /m option.*

WORKING WITH MACROS

MACRO HOT KEYS

You can execute a macro by pressing a single key or key combination called a hot key. You can assign a hot key to a macro when you create it. Eighty-two hot keys are available:

- The function keys F2 through F9, and F11 and F12. (F1 is reserved for Help and F10 for closing dialog boxes.)
- The function keys F1 through F12 combined with the Shift key.
- The function keys F1 through F12 combined with the Ctrl key.
- The function keys F1 through F12 combined with the Alt key.
- The Alt key combined with the letters A-Z and the digits 0-9.

Keep these points in mind about macro hot keys:

- The Alt key combined with the letters F, E, V, I, S, L, U, and H access the WordStar pull-down menus. If you use any of these keystrokes as hot keys, you can't use them for those menus. (You can still display the menus using a mouse or using the Right and Left Arrow keys in the menu bar.)
- You don't have to assign a hot key to each macro. If a macro is not assigned a hot key, you can run the macro using the Play command (or the MP classic command).
- If you want to assign a hot key to a macro that doesn't have one, or change the hot key assigned to a macro, use Macros→Rename, or ME. Don't use Macros→Record (MR); it will erase the macro and create a new one.
- WordStar comes with predefined macros for most of the function key hot keys and for several other hot keys. These macros are listed in Appendix D, "Function Keys and Other Macros." You can define new macros for these keys if you want, using Record (MR) or Edit/Create (MD).

Macro files and directories

Each macro is stored as a file, with the name you gave it while recording or editing and the .WSM extension.

CAUTION *When you record, create, or edit a macro and save it, WordStar compiles the macro, adding executable code. Macro files appear to be nondocuments (ASCII files) when you edit them, but they contain other information. You must edit them with Macros→Create/Edit (or MD) to get usable macros.*

On most systems, all the macro files are stored in one directory. The default macro directory name is WS\MACROS; you can change it with WSCHANGE (CD2G).

Play

Pull-down: ***ALT + U, M, P***
Classic: ***MP***

Executes a macro.

You can execute a macro either using a hot key or using this command. For an explanation on using hot keys, see "Macro Hot Keys" in this section.

Follow these steps to play a macro:

1. Choose Utilities→Macros→Play, or use the MP classic command.
2. In the Play Macro dialog box, specify the macro to play. You can choose the macro either by name or hot key. When you press the Down Arrow key and scroll through the list of macros, the description for the highlighted macro appears in the dialog box.
3. Press F10 or choose OK.

WordStar executes all the commands and enters all the text specified in the macro. Generally, menus and dialog boxes are not displayed unless you need to enter input.

You can stop the macro by pressing Esc or ^Break. (When a macro is paused for input, you must use ^Break.)

RECORD

Pull-down: ***ALT + U, M, R***
Classic: ***MR***

Records a series of keystrokes and stores them as a macro that you can execute.

You can create a macro by choosing Record and then pressing all the keystrokes that you want in the macro. Follow these steps:

1 Choose Utilities→Macros→Record, or use the MR classic command.

2 In the Record Macro dialog box, type the name you want to give the macro. If the macro name is already in use, confirm that you want to redefine the macro, or specify another name.

3 Specify the hot key that will execute the macro. You can press the Down Arrow key and scroll through the list to see which hot keys are available. If the hot key you specify is already in use, confirm that you want to reassign the hot key or specify another hot key. If you don't want to assign a hot key to the macro, you can skip this step.

4 Type a description of the macro to remind you of what it does and to help you find it in the list. The description can be up to 48 characters long. If you don't want to give a description for the macro, you can skip this step.

5 Press F10 or choose OK.

6 Enter all the keystrokes you want in the macro. Enter them in the same way you want to play them back when you run the macro.

You may need the macro to pause when you run it so that you can enter information such as a filename. At any place you want the macro to pause, press Alt+hyphen. Then type any number of keystrokes as an example of the input. Press Alt+hyphen again to end the pause, and continue entering the macro keystrokes. When you execute the macro, it pauses at that point for input and continues after you press Alt+hyphen. (You can change the Alt+hyphen keystroke to another keystroke in WSCHANGE (DCDB).)

Note: Mouse actions and clicks are not recorded in macros and do not work while you are recording a macro; you must use the keyboard.

7 When you finish entering the keystrokes, press Alt+= (hold down the Alt key and press =). (You can change the Alt+= keystroke to another keystroke using WSCHANGE (DCDA).)

WordStar records and compiles the macro. If you want to make adjustments to the macro, you can either record it again or edit it using Macros→Edit/Create, or the MD classic command.

EDIT/CREATE

Pull-down: ***ALT + U, M, E***
Classic: ***MD***

Creates and modifies a macro that contains keystrokes and commands that you enter.

Each macro consists of a series of WordStar commands and functions. You edit a macro using the same commands you use for editing a nondocument file. Follow these steps:

1 Choose Utilities→Macros→Edit/Create, or use the MD classic command.

2 In the Edit/Create Macro dialog box, specify the macro name.

When you press the Down Arrow key and scroll through the list of macros, the description for the highlighted macro appears in the dialog box.

3 If you're creating a new macro, specify the hot key that will execute the macro. You can press the Down Arrow key and scroll through the list to see which hot keys are available. If the hot key you specify is already in use, confirm that you want to reassign the hot key or specify another hot key. If you don't want to assign a hot key to the macro, you can skip this step.

4 Type a description of the macro to remind you of what it does and to help you find it in the list. The description can be up to 48 characters long. If you don't want to give a description for the macro, you can skip this step.

5 Press F10 or choose OK. WordStar opens a full-screen editing window for the macro.

6 Type the text of the macro or make any editing changes. For information about what you can enter, see "The Macro Language" in "Macros" in "Editing Screen Utilities Menu." When you edit a macro, you can use the commands used for editing nondocuments.

TIP You may want to periodically use File→Save (^KS) to save your changes while editing.

7 When you finish, save the macro using File→Save and Close (^KD).

WordStar compiles the macro. If it finds any syntax errors or other errors, they are entered into the macro file. You must edit the macro again to correct the errors.

Errors in a macro file are noted by a message describing the error, followed by the line of the macro that contains the error, with a caret (^) below the line pointing to the location of the error.

TIP The Alt+D hot key is preassigned to a macro that goes to the next error message in a macro file. This is helpful when you edit macros to fix errors.

If you want to copy a block of text from one macro into another, be sure to start from the Opening screen. Choose Macros→Edit/Create (or MD), and then choose File→Open/Switch (or ^OK). Then copy the block between the windows in the same way you would while editing a document.

SINGLE STEP

Pull-down: ALT + U, M, S
Classic: MS

Plays back a macro one step at a time to locate errors.

After you create or edit a macro, you can play it back step by step to identify any problems. This command is helpful when a macro doesn't work exactly as you expect it to. Follow these steps:

1 Choose Utilities→Macros→Single Step, or use the MS classic command.

2 In the Single Step dialog box, specify the macro to play. You can specify the macro either by name or by hot key. When you press the Down Arrow key and scroll through the list of macros, the description for the highlighted macro appears in the dialog box.

3 Press F10 or choose OK.

WordStar executes the first command or keystroke in the macro, and pauses.

4 Press the Spacebar to continue to the next command, function, or keystroke. Continue in this manner until the macro finishes. You can stop running the macro by pressing Esc or ^Break. (When a macro is paused for input, you must use ^Break.)

COPY

Pull-down: ***ALT + U, M, C***
Classic: ***MO***

Copies a macro.

If you want to create a macro similar to another one, you can copy the first macro and edit the copy. You can also make copies of macros so that several people can use them on their computers. Follow these steps:

1 Choose Utilities→Macros→Copy, or use the MO classic command.

2 In the Copy Macro dialog box, specify the macro to copy.

You can specify the macro either by name or by hot key. When you press the Down Arrow key and scroll through the list of macros, the description for the highlighted macro appears in the dialog box.

3 Specify the macro name for the new copy. Type the path with the name if necessary. If the name is already in use, confirm that you want to overwrite the current macro.

4 Press F10 or choose OK to copy the macro.

The copied macro has the same description as the original, but is not assigned a hot key. You can assign a hot key and description when you edit the macro, or you can use Rename Macro (or the ME classic command).

DELETE

Pull-down: ***ALT + U, M, D***
Classic: ***MY***

Deletes a macro.

Follow these steps to delete a macro:

1 Choose Utilities→Macros→Delete, or use the MY classic command.

2 In the Delete Macro dialog box, specify the macro to delete. You can specify the macro either by name or by hot key. When you press the Down Arrow key and scroll through the list of macros, the description for the highlighted macro appears in the dialog box.

3 Press F10 or choose OK to delete the macro, and confirm the deletion.

RENAME

Pull-down: ***ALT + U, M, N***
Classic: ***ME***

Renames a macro.

You can use this command to rename a macro, assign a new hot key, or add or edit a description. Follow these steps:

1 Choose Utilities→Macros→Rename, or use the ME classic command.

2 In the Rename Macro dialog box, specify the macro to rename. You can specify the macro either by name or by hot key. When you press the Down Arrow key and scroll through the list of macros, the description for the highlighted macro appears in the dialog box.

3 Specify the new macro name, hot key, and/or description. If the name or hot key is already in use, confirm that you want to overwrite the current assignment.

4 Press F10 or choose OK to rename the macro.